Through his speech, the former chairperson of the Drafting Committee of the Constitution told the nation that the Supreme Court had got its interpretive analysis of the Constitution completely wrong. On occasion, his criticism of the court turned especially trenchant. His use of the expression 'utterly unsatisfactory' to describe the judgement drew protests from the house and admonishment from the chair. As the atmosphere calmed, Ambedkar produced a witty riposte: 'I have often in the course of my practice told the presiding Judge in very emphatic terms that I am bound to obey his judgement, but I am not bound to respect it. That is the liberty which every lawyer brings in telling the Judge that his judgement is wrong and I am not prepared to give up that liberty.'[28] This speech, lasting over a hundred minutes, was described as 'one of the most outstanding debating performances witnessed in this Parliament' in the *Times of India*.[29]

If Ambedkar presented the legal case, Nehru presented the political case. He rejected the criticism that this amendment adopted a 'communal approach' to the problem, observing that the government's intention was simply to uplift the backward classes. The bill was referred to a select committee of Parliament. The only significant alteration in respect of the amendment that overturned the court's judgement was that the word 'economic' was dropped.[30] That is, the amendment stated that neither Article 15 nor Article 29(2) would prevent the state from making special provisions for the 'educational and social' interests of the backward classes.

The Constitution was amended, and the Dorairajan judgement was overturned efficiently, in a matter of two months. The *Economic and Political Weekly* declared that '[a]t last, after a great deal of controversy, New Delhi saved the Madras Ministry by saving the Communal G.O.'[31]

In some respects, the decision of the Supreme Court in Dorairajan was repudiated in the years that followed. Following that decision, the principle of reservations in educational institutions for scheduled castes, scheduled tribes and socially and educationally backward classes was accepted by the courts.[32] Professor Tripathi would live to see the day when the pendulum swung away from the court's initial position that directive principles were subsidiary to fundamental rights.[33] Directive principles would no longer be